

500 IELTS Antonyms

Essential Opposites for All Four Skills

● Writing

● Reading

● Listening

● Speaking

● All Skills

Total Words: 500 — organised alphabetically with skill tags

A

abandon

✗ maintain

Writing

abstract

✗ concrete

Writing

accept

✗ reject

Writing

accurate

✗ misleading

Writing

active

✗ passive

All Skills

adapt

✗ resist

Writing

adequate

✗ insufficient

Writing

advance

✗ retreat

Writing

adverse

✗ favourable

Writing

affluent

✗ poor

Reading

allow

✗ prohibit

Writing

ancient

✗ modern

Reading

apparent

✗ hidden

Writing

approve

✗ reject

Writing

argue

✗ agree

Writing

artificial

✗ natural

Writing

ascend

✗ descend

Writing

assert

✗ deny

Writing

attain

✗ fail

Writing

attract

✗ repel

Writing

authoritative

✗ unreliable

Reading

aware

✗ oblivious

Writing

abundance

✗ scarcity

Writing

accelerate

✗ decelerate

Writing

accessible

✗ exclusive

*Writing***achievement**

✗ failure

*Writing***acquire**

✗ lose

*Writing***advantage**

✗ drawback

*Writing***aid**

✗ hinder

*Writing***alleviate**

✗ worsen

*Writing***ambitious**

✗ complacent

*Speaking***amplify**

✗ reduce

*Writing***analyse**

✗ ignore

*Writing***anonymous**

✗ identified

*Reading***appropriate**

✗ unsuitable

*Writing***arrest**

✗ release

*Reading***assist**

✗ obstruct

*Writing***authority**

✗ subordinate

*Writing***available**

✗ scarce

*Writing***acknowledge**

✗ deny

*Reading***ambiguous**

✗ clear

*Reading***arrival**

✗ departure

*Listening***achieve**

✗ fail

*Speaking***adventurous**

✗ cautious

*Speaking***anxious**

✗ calm

*Speaking***aggressive**

✗ peaceful

*Writing***alert**

✗ unaware

*Writing***allocate**

✗ withhold

*Writing***alternative**

✗ compulsory

*Writing***appealing**

✗ repulsive

*Writing***associate**

✗ separate

*Writing***attempt**

✗ abandon

*Writing***authorise**

✗ ban

*Writing***accumulate**

✗ disperse

*Writing***advocate**

✗ oppose

*Writing***ambivalent**

✗ certain

*Reading***adamant**

✗ flexible

Speaking

apprehensive

✗ confident

*Speaking***articulate**

✗ incoherent

*Speaking***assertive**

✗ passive

*Speaking***absorb**

✗ emit

*Writing***acclaim**

✗ criticise

*Writing***acute**

✗ chronic

*Reading***adhere**

✗ deviate

*Writing***affluence**

✗ poverty

*Writing***aggravate**

✗ soothe

*Writing***analytical**

✗ intuitive

*Writing***anchor**

✗ destabilise

*Writing***antagonise**

✗ reconcile

*Writing***anticipate**

✗ overlook

*Writing***arbitrary**

✗ systematic

*Writing***arduous**

✗ effortless

*Writing***assimilate**

✗ exclude

*Writing***attentive**

✗ negligent

*Writing***authentic**

✗ counterfeit

*Writing***autonomous**

✗ controlled

*Writing***aggregate**

✗ individual

*Writing***amplification**

✗ reduction

*Writing***antagonist**

✗ ally

*Reading***ascertain**

✗ guess

*Reading***attest**

✗ deny

*Reading***attribute**

✗ deny

*Writing***B****ban**

✗ allow

*Writing***beneficial**

✗ harmful

*Writing***bold**

✗ timid

Speaking

boom

✗ decline

*Writing***broad**

✗ narrow

*Writing***build**

✗ destroy

*Writing***balanced**

✗ biased

*Writing***barrier**

✗ opportunity

*Writing***basic**

✗ advanced

*Writing***benefit**

✗ drawback

*Writing***bias**

✗ fairness

*Writing***brief**

✗ lengthy

*Writing***burden**

✗ relief

*Writing***brave**

✗ cowardly

*Speaking***broaden**

✗ narrow

*Writing***biased**

✗ neutral

*Reading***brevity**

✗ verbosity

*Writing***C****capable**

✗ incompetent

*Writing***certain**

✗ doubtful

*Writing***coherent**

✗ disjointed

*Writing***complex**

✗ simple

*Writing***compulsory**

✗ optional

*Writing***confident**

✗ insecure

*Speaking***consistent**

✗ unpredictable

*Writing***constructive**

✗ destructive

*Writing***controversial**

✗ accepted

*Writing***cooperative**

✗ antagonistic

*Writing***creative**

✗ unimaginative

*Writing***crucial**

✗ trivial

*Writing***current**

✗ outdated

*Writing***cause**

✗ effect

*Writing***centralise**

✗ decentralise

Writing

clarity X confusion <i>Writing</i>	collapse X recover <i>Writing</i>	competitive X cooperative <i>Writing</i>
concentrated X dispersed <i>Writing</i>	confirm X deny <i>Writing</i>	connect X isolate <i>Writing</i>
conscious X oblivious <i>Writing</i>	conservative X progressive <i>Writing</i>	contribute X withdraw <i>Writing</i>
control X freedom <i>Writing</i>	converge X diverge <i>Reading</i>	convince X dissuade <i>Writing</i>
create X destroy <i>Writing</i>	credible X dubious <i>Reading</i>	crowded X empty <i>Writing</i>
cultural X universal <i>Writing</i>	claim X deny <i>Reading</i>	conclude X question <i>Reading</i>
contradict X support <i>Reading</i>	cheerful X sad <i>Speaking</i>	comfortable X unsettling <i>Speaking</i>
curious X indifferent <i>Speaking</i>	cautious X reckless <i>Writing</i>	committed X indifferent <i>Writing</i>
concise X verbose <i>Writing</i>	corrupt X honest <i>Writing</i>	clarify X confuse <i>Writing</i>
challenge X opportunity <i>Writing</i>	compel X discourage <i>Writing</i>	compensate X penalise <i>Writing</i>
consent X refuse <i>Writing</i>	cumulative X isolated <i>Writing</i>	contentious X uncontested <i>Reading</i>

candid

✗ evasive

*Speaking***compelling**

✗ unconvincing

*Speaking***cynical**

✗ optimistic

*Speaking***coherence**

✗ fragmentation

*Writing***collaborate**

✗ compete

*Writing***convey**

✗ conceal

*Writing***cease**

✗ persist

*Writing***chronic**

✗ temporary

*Reading***coerce**

✗ persuade

*Writing***competent**

✗ incapable

*Writing***concede**

✗ insist

*Writing***condemn**

✗ praise

*Writing***consolidate**

✗ fragment

*Writing***catalyst**

✗ inhibitor

*Writing***causation**

✗ coincidence

*Writing***circulate**

✗ contain

*Writing***coexist**

✗ conflict

*Writing***cohesion**

✗ division

*Writing***coincide**

✗ diverge

*Reading***commence**

✗ terminate

*Writing***complexity**

✗ simplicity

*Writing***condone**

✗ condemn

*Writing***confine**

✗ liberate

*Writing***D****definite**

✗ uncertain

*Writing***demand**

✗ supply

*Writing***dense**

✗ sparse

*Reading***dependent**

✗ self-sufficient

*Writing***develop**

✗ decline

*Writing***difficult**

✗ easy

All Skills

diverse

✗ uniform

*Writing***dominant**

✗ subordinate

*Writing***domestic**

✗ international

*Writing***dynamic**

✗ static

*Writing***decline**

✗ improvement

*Writing***defend**

✗ attack

*Writing***delay**

✗ accelerate

*Writing***democratic**

✗ authoritarian

*Writing***deplete**

✗ replenish

*Writing***deserve**

✗ forfeit

*Writing***deteriorate**

✗ improve

*Writing***devote**

✗ neglect

*Writing***diminish**

✗ increase

*Writing***discourage**

✗ encourage

*Writing***disrupt**

✗ stabilise

*Writing***distribute**

✗ collect

*Writing***doubt**

✗ certainty

*Writing***drive**

✗ discourage

*Writing***deduce**

✗ assume

*Reading***disputable**

✗ certain

*Reading***determined**

✗ indecisive

*Speaking***disappointed**

✗ pleased

*Speaking***decisive**

✗ hesitant

*Writing***dedicated**

✗ uncommitted

*Writing***desirable**

✗ unappealing

*Writing***detailed**

✗ vague

*Writing***derive**

✗ discard

*Writing***deviate**

✗ conform

*Writing***distort**

✗ clarify

*Writing***disproportionate**

✗ balanced

*Writing***daunting**

✗ manageable

*Speaking***deceptive**

✗ transparent

*Writing***deficient**

✗ sufficient

Writing

durable

✗ fragile

*Writing***dwindle**

✗ increase

*Writing***deliberate**

✗ spontaneous

*Writing***deprive**

✗ grant

*Writing***dismantle**

✗ construct

*Writing***dormant**

✗ active

*Writing***E****effective**

✗ futile

*Writing***efficient**

✗ wasteful

*Writing***equal**

✗ inequitable

*Writing***essential**

✗ unnecessary

*Writing***ethical**

✗ corrupt

*Writing***evident**

✗ unclear

*Writing***excessive**

✗ moderate

*Writing***explicit**

✗ implicit

*Reading***export**

✗ import

*Writing***educated**

✗ uninformed

*Writing***emphasise**

✗ downplay

*Writing***enable**

✗ prevent

*Writing***enforce**

✗ relax

*Writing***enhance**

✗ diminish

*Writing***enormous**

✗ tiny

*Writing***ensure**

✗ risk

*Writing***established**

✗ new

*Writing***exceed**

✗ fall short

*Writing***expensive**

✗ cheap

*All Skills***exploit**

✗ protect

*Writing***expose**

✗ conceal

*Writing***extend**

✗ shorten

*Writing***extreme**

✗ moderate

*Writing***empirical**

✗ theoretical

Reading

enthusiastic

✗ apathetic

*Speaking***exciting**

✗ dull

*Speaking***elaborate**

✗ simple

*Writing***emerge**

✗ disappear

*Writing***evaluate**

✗ overlook

*Writing***evolve**

✗ stagnate

*Writing***exacerbate**

✗ alleviate

*Writing***eloquent**

✗ inarticulate

*Speaking***empathetic**

✗ indifferent

*Speaking***escalate**

✗ de-escalate

*Writing***endure**

✗ succumb

*Writing***erode**

✗ strengthen

*Writing***exclusion**

✗ inclusion

*Writing***F****fair**

✗ biased

*Writing***famous**

✗ unknown

*Writing***flexible**

✗ rigid

*Writing***formal**

✗ casual

*Speaking***frequent**

✗ rare

*Writing***future**

✗ past

*Writing***fail**

✗ succeed

*All Skills***familiar**

✗ alien

*Speaking***finite**

✗ inexhaustible

*Writing***focus**

✗ distract

*Writing***force**

✗ persuade

*Writing***fundamental**

✗ trivial

*Writing***factual**

✗ fictional

*Reading***friendly**

✗ hostile

*Speaking***favourable**

✗ detrimental

Writing

flourish

✗ decline

*Writing***focused**

✗ distracted

*Writing***fragile**

✗ robust

*Writing***freedom**

✗ restriction

*Writing***facilitate**

✗ obstruct

*Writing***fluctuate**

✗ stabilise

*Writing***fluctuation**

✗ stability

*Writing***foster**

✗ hinder

*Writing***fragment**

✗ unify

*Writing***feasible**

✗ impractical

*Writing***fragmented**

✗ cohesive

*Writing***frugal**

✗ extravagant

*Speaking***futile**

✗ productive

*Writing***G****gain**

✗ lose

*Writing***general**

✗ specific

*Writing***genuine**

✗ fake

*Writing***global**

✗ local

*Writing***gradual**

✗ sudden

*Writing***grow**

✗ shrink

*Writing***guilty**

✗ innocent

*Reading***generous**

✗ selfish

*Speaking***growth**

✗ contraction

*Writing***generate**

✗ consume

*Writing***groundbreaking**

✗ conventional

*Writing***H****harm**

✗ benefit

*Writing***harsh**

✗ mild

*Writing***honest**

✗ deceptive

Writing

hopeful

✗ hopeless

*Speaking***huge**

✗ tiny

*Writing***heavy**

✗ light

*All Skills***helpful**

✗ harmful

*Writing***hidden**

✗ visible

*Writing***homogeneous**

✗ diverse

*Writing***humble**

✗ arrogant

*Speaking***hypothesis**

✗ fact

*Reading***heighten**

✗ reduce

*Writing***hamper**

✗ assist

*Writing***hypothetical**

✗ factual

Reading

I

identical

✗ different

*Reading***ignorant**

✗ knowledgeable

*Writing***improve**

✗ worsen

*Writing***include**

✗ exclude

*Writing***indirect**

✗ direct

*Writing***innovative**

✗ conventional

*Writing***insignificant**

✗ significant

*Writing***insufficient**

✗ sufficient

*Writing***intentional**

✗ accidental

*Writing***irrelevant**

✗ relevant

*Writing***ideal**

✗ flawed

*Writing***ignore**

✗ address

*Writing***impartial**

✗ biased

*Writing***important**

✗ trivial

*Writing***impose**

✗ remove

*Writing***incentive**

✗ deterrent

*Writing***indifferent**

✗ passionate

*Speaking***individual**

✗ collective

Writing

inequality

✗ equality

*Writing***inflate**

✗ deflate

*Writing***inhibit**

✗ encourage

*Writing***injustice**

✗ justice

*Writing***isolated**

✗ connected

*Writing***implied**

✗ stated

*Reading***infer**

✗ state

*Reading***interesting**

✗ dull

*Speaking***implement**

✗ abandon

*Writing***inclusive**

✗ exclusive

*Writing***inevitable**

✗ avoidable

*Writing***influential**

✗ powerless

*Writing***innovation**

✗ stagnation

*Writing***inconclusive**

✗ definitive

*Reading***impede**

✗ facilitate

*Writing***imminent**

✗ distant

*Reading***incentivise**

✗ deter

*Writing***inconsistent**

✗ uniform

*Writing***indispensable**

✗ redundant

*Writing***innate**

✗ acquired

*Reading***intervene**

✗ withdraw

*Writing***irreversible**

✗ reversible

*Writing***J****justified**

✗ arbitrary

*Writing***justify**

✗ question

*Writing***K****keep**

✗ discard

All Skills

L

legal

✗ illegal

*Writing***lenient**

✗ strict

*Writing***likely**

✗ improbable

*Writing***limited**

✗ boundless

*Writing***logical**

✗ illogical

*Writing***long-term**

✗ short-term

*Writing***lessen**

✗ increase

*Writing***literal**

✗ figurative

*Reading***lack**

✗ abundance

*Writing***lengthen**

✗ shorten

Writing

M

major

✗ minor

*Writing***maximum**

✗ minimum

*Writing***meaningful**

✗ meaningless

*Writing***modern**

✗ traditional

*Writing***moral**

✗ corrupt

*Writing***motivated**

✗ demotivated

*Speaking***maintain**

✗ neglect

*Writing***majority**

✗ minority

*Writing***maximise**

✗ minimise

*Writing***mislead**

✗ inform

*Writing***modify**

✗ keep

*Writing***memorable**

✗ forgettable

*Speaking***measurable**

✗ vague

*Writing***mitigate**

✗ worsen

*Writing***meticulous**

✗ careless

*Writing***marginalise**

✗ empower

Writing

N

negative

✗ positive

*All Skills***numerous**

✗ few

*Writing***neglect**

✗ care for

*Writing***novel**

✗ outdated

*Writing***necessary**

✗ redundant

*Writing***nervous**

✗ relaxed

*Speaking***nuanced**

✗ simplistic

Reading

O

objective

✗ subjective

*Writing***obvious**

✗ obscure

*Writing***optimistic**

✗ pessimistic

*Speaking***original**

✗ copied

*Writing***outweigh**

✗ underperform

*Writing***obscure**

✗ clear

*Writing***oppose**

✗ support

*Writing***orderly**

✗ chaotic

*Writing***overestimate**

✗ underestimate

*Writing***opinion**

✗ fact

*Reading***optimise**

✗ neglect

Writing

P

powerful

✗ weak

*Writing***practical**

✗ idealistic

*Writing***precise**

✗ vague

*Writing***prevalent**

✗ rare

*Writing***productive**

✗ counterproductive

*Writing***progressive**

✗ regressive

Writing

public

✗ private

*Writing***partial**

✗ one-sided

*Writing***peaceful**

✗ violent

*Writing***plentiful**

✗ scarce

*Writing***pollute**

✗ clean

*Writing***poor**

✗ wealthy

*Writing***prevent**

✗ allow

*Writing***primary**

✗ secondary

*Writing***progress**

✗ decline

*Writing***promote**

✗ discourage

*Writing***protect**

✗ harm

*Writing***plausible**

✗ far-fetched

*Reading***patient**

✗ impulsive

*Speaking***pleasant**

✗ disagreeable

*Speaking***polite**

✗ rude

*Speaking***popular**

✗ marginal

*Writing***proud**

✗ ashamed

*Speaking***proportional**

✗ skewed

*Writing***pragmatic**

✗ idealistic

*Speaking***paradoxical**

✗ logical

*Reading***pervasive**

✗ localised

*Reading***postulate**

✗ disprove

*Reading***predominant**

✗ minor

*Writing***prolific**

✗ unproductive

Writing

Q

quantitative

✗ qualitative

Reading

R

rapid

✗ slow

*Writing***rational**

✗ impulsive

*Writing***realistic**

✗ idealistic

Writing

reliable X inconsistent <i>Reading</i>	rich X poor <i>Writing</i>	rare X common <i>Writing</i>
recover X decline <i>Writing</i>	reduce X increase <i>Writing</i>	refuse X accept <i>Writing</i>
release X restrict <i>Writing</i>	remote X accessible <i>Writing</i>	renewable X finite <i>Writing</i>
restrict X free <i>Writing</i>	reveal X conceal <i>Writing</i>	reward X punish <i>Writing</i>
rewarding X futile <i>Speaking</i>	redundant X essential <i>Writing</i>	regulate X deregulate <i>Writing</i>
resilient X fragile <i>Writing</i>	restore X damage <i>Writing</i>	reconcile X aggravate <i>Writing</i>
rigid X adaptable <i>Writing</i>		

S

secure X vulnerable <i>Writing</i>	skilled X incompetent <i>Writing</i>	stable X turbulent <i>Writing</i>
standard X substandard <i>Writing</i>	successful X futile <i>Writing</i>	sustainable X destructive <i>Writing</i>
scarce X abundant <i>Writing</i>	sharp X gradual <i>Writing</i>	solve X create <i>Writing</i>

spend

✗ save

*Writing***spread**

✗ contain

*Writing***strengthen**

✗ weaken

*Writing***superficial**

✗ deep

*Writing***surge**

✗ decline

*Writing***structured**

✗ chaotic

*Writing***supported**

✗ contested

*Reading***satisfied**

✗ discontented

*Speaking***serious**

✗ trivial

*Speaking***sociable**

✗ antisocial

*Speaking***stress**

✗ relaxation

*Speaking***surprising**

✗ expected

*Speaking***sophisticated**

✗ primitive

*Writing***subsidise**

✗ tax

*Writing***scrutinise**

✗ overlook

*Reading***sceptical**

✗ credulous

*Speaking***supplement**

✗ reduce

Writing

T

transparent

✗ opaque

*Writing***trivial**

✗ significant

*Writing***tense**

✗ relaxed

*Speaking***threat**

✗ opportunity

*Writing***trust**

✗ suspicion

*Writing***theoretical**

✗ practical

*Reading***talented**

✗ mediocre

*Speaking***tiring**

✗ energising

*Speaking***tentative**

✗ definitive

*Reading***tangible**

✗ abstract

*Writing***terminate**

✗ initiate

Writing

U

unity

✗ division

*Writing***understandable**

✗ confusing

*Speaking***unique**

✗ ordinary

*Speaking***unified**

✗ divided

*Writing***unanimous**

✗ divided

*Reading***unprecedented**

✗ commonplace

*Writing***V****valid**

✗ flawed

*Writing***vulnerable**

✗ resilient

*Writing***vibrant**

✗ dull

*Writing***validate**

✗ refute

*Writing***verify**

✗ dispute

*Writing***W****willing**

✗ reluctant

*Speaking***worthwhile**

✗ worthless

*Writing***waste**

✗ conserve

*Writing***widen**

✗ narrow

*Writing***worried**

✗ calm

*Speaking***widespread**

✗ localised

*Writing***Y****yield**

✗ resist

Writing